

HR Hrvatska / Croatia (HR) — Registar dokumenata / Document Registry

Sustav zdravstvenog odgoja / Health Education System: Zdravstveni odgoj — mandatory cross-curricular; Biologija; Tjelesna i zdravstvena kultura

Bioregion: Mediterranean / Pannonian

Reform Status: Kurikulum 2019 reform; ongoing curriculum implementation; prigovor savjesti (conscience objection) context

Ovaj registar sadrži popis svih identificiranih izvornih dokumenata za Hrvatsku u projektu OneHealth EU.

This registry lists all source documents identified for Croatia in the OneHealth EU project.

System Overview

Croatia introduced health education (*Zdravstveni odgoj*) as a mandatory cross-curricular subject in 2012, generating significant public controversy. The current framework is governed by the **Kurikulum 2019** reform, which reorganised health education as a **cross-curricular theme** integrated across Biology (*Biologija*), Physical Education (*Tjelesna i zdravstvena kultura*), and other subjects. A distinctive feature is the **prigovor savjesti** (conscience objection) provision, which allows teachers to opt out of teaching certain health education content (particularly related to sexuality), a unique arrangement in the EU. The **Agencija za odgoj i obrazovanje (AZOO)** and the **Ministarstvo znanosti i obrazovanja (MZO)** are the key authorities.

A. Pravni okvir / Legal Framework

1. Zakon o odgoju i obrazovanju u osnovnoj i srednjoj školi (ZOOOSŠ)

- **Type:** Act of Parliament / Zakon | **Year:** 2008 (as amended)
 - **Publisher:** Hrvatski sabor / MZO
 - **Description:** The foundational Croatian education law. Provides legal basis for curriculum decisions, cross-curricular themes, and the *prigovor savjesti* provision for teachers in health education. Contains provisions about the role of parents and the Catholic Church's influence in Croatian schools.
 - **Access (Zakon.hr):** <https://www.zakon.hr/z/317/Zakon-o-odgoju-i-obrazovanju-u-osnovnoj-i-srednjoj-%C5%A1koli>
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2. Nacionalni kurikulum za osnovnoškolski odgoj i obrazovanje (NK OŠ) — Zdravstveni odgoj

- **Type:** National curriculum / Nacionalni kurikulum | **Year:** 2019 (Kurikulum reform)
- **Publisher:** MZO / AZOO

- **Description:** Croatia's 2019 national curriculum reform restructured health education as a cross-curricular theme. Defines health competencies integrated into Biology, Physical Education, and other subjects. The reform followed controversy around the 2012 *Zdravstveni odgoj* programme and the subsequent *prigovor savjesti* debates.
- **Access (Kurikulum.hr):** <https://kurikulum.gov.hr/>

B. Zdravstveni podaci / Health Data

3. HBSC Hrvatska 2022 — Health Behaviour in School-aged Children

- **Type:** Research report | **Year:** 2022 | **Publisher:** HZZJZ (Croatian Institute of Public Health) / WHO
- **Description:** Croatia's contribution to the international HBSC study. Data on health behaviours, wellbeing, and risk behaviours of Croatian adolescents. Coordinated by the Croatian Institute of Public Health (HZZJZ).
- **Access (HZZJZ):** <https://www.hzzjz.hr/sluzbe/sluzba-za-epidemiologiju/hbsc/>

C. Analytical Files in Project Repository (NotebookLM)

File	Contents
HR_ZO_Pravni_Okvir_Kurikulum2019_PrigovorSavjesti_KK_2025.md	Legal framework — Education Act, Kurikulum 2019, <i>prigovor savjesti</i> context
HR_ZO_Curriculum_HBSC2022_OneHealth_FAQ_22Zemlja.md	Curriculum content, HBSC 2022 data, One Health context, FAQ comparing 22 countries

Registry compiled: 2026-05-29 | Project: OneHealth EU